

WEDE 5020 Project Proposal 2

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Table of Contents

Table of Contents	1
Organization Overview	1
Mission Statement	2
Vision Statement	2
Target Audience	2
Website Goals and Objectives	2
Key Performance Indicator(KPIs)	3
Current Website Analysis	3
Proposed Website Features and Functionality	4
Core web pages	4
Additional Features	5
Design and User Experience	6
Overall Design Aesthetic and Branding	7
Colour Scheme	7
Typography and Hierarchy	7
Layout and Design	7
User Experience Strategy	7
Technical Requirements	8
Hosting and Domain	8
Programming Languages	8
Frameworks and Tools	9
Timeline and Milestones	9
Budget	11
Development costs	11
Hosting and Domain Costs	11
Maintenance and Support	11
Total Estimated Budget	11
References	11

Table of Contents	1
Organization Overview	1
Mission Statement	2
Vision Statement	2

Target Audience.....	2
Website Goals and Objectives.....	2
Key Performance Indicator(KPIs)	3
Current Website Analysis	3
Proposed Website Features and Functionality	4
Core web pages	4
Additional Features.....	5
Design and User Experience.....	6
Overall Design Aesthetic and Branding.....	7
Colour Scheme	7
Typography and Hierarchy	7
Layout and Design	7
User Experience Strategy.....	7
Technical Requirements	8
Hosting and Domain	8
Programming Languages	8
Frameworks and Tools.....	9
Timeline and Milestones	9
Budget.....	11
Development costs.....	11
Hosting and Domain Costs	11
Maintenance and Support	11
Total Estimated Budget.....	11
References	11

1.Organization Overview

Meet Hermosa Flor, started in 2019 from the vision of entrepreneur Mbalenhle Sebapu, Hermosa Flor is more than just a beauty brand, it's a south African success story. Mbalenhle started the company to fill a gap in the market; high quality, effective skincare and cosmetics that don't break the bank and most importantly, actually celebrates the diversity of African skin. What began as a passionate project has bloomed into a beloved household name, reaching people across the country through a vibrant online community and a seamless e-commerce experience.

Mission Statement

Our mission is simple; we want you to feel like best version of yourself. We provide premium beauty and skincare essentials that empower you to embrace your natural glow and express your unique personality with confidence

Vision Statement

We aren't just looking at the local scene, we have our sights set on the world. Our vision is to become a global leader in the beauty industry, known for our innovative formulas, inclusive spirit and a deep commitment to excellence that evolves alongside our customers.

Target Audience

We designed Hermosa Flor for:

- Young Adults and working professionals (age 18- 45)
- Individuals interested in skin care
- Predominantly women, while also appealing to a broader, inclusive market

2. Website Goals and Objectives

The core of Hermosa Flor website is to be more than just digital storefront, it's a space where shopping meets community. We've designed the platform to offer a smooth, secure e-commerce journey while building the kind of brand that turns first time buyer into lifelong fans.

Website Goals

Boosting Sales: We aim to make shopping effortless. By focusing on clear product details, transparent pricing and easy checkout, we ensure nothing stands between our customers and their products.

Brand Awareness: We are the site to cement our place as a trusted, inclusive African beauty authority through beautiful visuals and authentic storytelling.

Improve User Engagement: Encourage user to spend more time on the website through interactive content such as blogs, tutorials and product recommendations.

Provide Valuable Information: Educate customers about skincare routines, product pages and beauty tips to position the brand as an authority in the beauty industry.

Key Performance Indicator (KPIs)

KPI measures the success of the website, therefore the following will be used to measure the success of the website:

- Percentage of visitors who purchases
- Number of monthly visitors
- Percentage of users who browse through without ordering
- Time users spend on the website
- Number of newsletter sign-ups and account registration
- Number of carts abandonment rate

3.Current Website Analysis

Strengths of the Existing Website	Weaknesses of the Existing Website
Hermosa Flor website is built on a reliable e-commerce structure, allow easy interaction for users	The homepage lacks the about page, the storytelling element
Products are organised into a collection	The design appears very simple and lacks modern interactive elements.
The websites adapt well to different screen sizes	Buttons such as “Shop now” are not prominent enough
The presence of a secure checkout system builds trust and online transaction increases sales.	There are minimal features such as product reviews, testimonials and blogs or tutorials that could help build trust and community.
Clean layout ensures users don’t get overwhelms	While functional, the navigation could be more intuitive with improved filtering.

Areas of Improvements

Based on the weaknesses identified above the following are the recommended improvements:

- Introduce About Section with the founder’s story, mission and brand values
- Implement modern design elements such as animation, dynamic banners and visually engaging layout to improve user experience
- Use bold, strategically placed CTA’s to increase conversions
- Integrated customer reviews, testimonials, blogs and video tutorials to educate customers

4. Proposed Website Features and Functionality

To bring Hermosa Flor website to life, the website needs to be as intuitive and beautiful as the products themselves. Here is the proposed blueprint for high performance and user-friendly platform.

Core web pages

Homepage

- Clear Call-to-Action
- Featured Products and best seller's sections
- Brand highlights
- Quick links to product categories

About Us Section

- Brand Story and background
- Mission and vision statements
- Founder introduction
- Brand values

Product Page

- Display of all products with images, prices and short description
- Product categorisation
- Advanced filtering
- Search functionality

Product Details Pages

- Detailed product description and benefits
- Customer reviews and rating
- “Add to cart” & “Buy Now” options

Enquiry Page

- Form for customer questions
- Fields for name, email, messages and product selection
- Option to subscribe to newsletters

Contact Page

- Business contact details
- Social Media Links
- Contact form

Additional Features

Shopping Cart & Checking System

- Add/Remove items
- Secure checkout with multiple payment options
- Order confirmation notifications

Search and Navigation

- Navigation bar with drop down menus
- Search bar

Personalisation Features:

- Skincare quiz for product recommendations
- Suggested products based on browsing behaviour

Content & Engagement

- Blog section
- Video / tutorial integration
- Customer testimonials

SEO and Performance Optimisation

- Meta tags and keywords
- Fast loading speed
- Mobile responsiveness

The aim is to create user-friendly, interactive and conversion focused website that not only showcases Hermosa flor's products but also enhances customer engagement and satisfaction.

5.Design and User Experience

Overall Design Aesthetic and Branding

The Hermosa Flor digital experience centers on a sophisticated, minimalist aesthetic that balances high-end luxury with an inclusive, welcoming spirit. By blending clean visuals with a polished, professional finish, the brand identity aims to inspire confidence and project a premium yet accessible image.

Colour Scheme

To maintain a warm and inviting user experience, the color scheme uses soft, organic tones accented by metallic finishes:

Primary Base: Blush pink, beige and crisp white to anchor the brand in simplicity and grace

Secondary Accents: Nudes and lavender to introduce layers of calm and refinement.

Highlights: Gold or rose gold accents to draw focus to Call- to Action and signify quality

Typography and Hierarchy

The font selection is curated to ensure both character and clarity across all devices:

- Headings – (Playfair Display) A timeless serif that communicates elegance
- Subheadings – (Montserrat) A modern sans-serif for structured navigation
- Body – (Open sans or Lato) Highly readable and detailed product insights

Structural Hierarchy: Clear scaling from bold H1 hero title down to standard body text ensures the user can scan information effortlessly.

Layout and Design

- Minimalist Design: Strategic use of white space to prevent cluster
- Visual Prioritization: High-resolution banners and product photography take centre stage
- Consistency: Uniform headers and footers provide a cohesive browsing experience from page to page

User Experience Strategy

- Simple user navigation with clear menu structures
- Fast loading speed to enhance user experience
- Clear readable fonts and colour contrast
- Well places buttons
- Easy browsing and Search Filters help users quickly find product based on their needs

6. Technical Requirements

To successfully develop and maintain the Hermosa Flor website, the following technical requirements are proposed:

Hosting and Domain

Domain Name: The website will continue using the existing domain `www.hermosaflor.africa`. This domain reflects the brand identity and geographic relevance, making it easy for customers to recognise and access.

Web Hosting: The website is currently hosted on an e-commerce platform which provides reliable uptime and fast loading speed, built in security with well-structured infrastructure to handle increased traffic and integrated payment gateway

Content Delivery Network: A CDN will be used to improve website performance by delivering content faster to users across different locations.

Programming Languages

Html5: is used to structure the content of the website

CSS3: is used to style the content and provide layout design and visual representation

JavaScript: is used to add interactivity such as dynamic content, form validation animations and product filtering

Frameworks and Tools

- **Frontend Frameworks:** Bootstrap for responsive design and faster UI development
- **E-commerce Platform:** Shopify for managing products, payments and orders
- **Version Control:** Git and GitHub for tracking changes, collaboration and project management
- **Development Tools:** Visual Studio, Browser developer tools for testing and debugging

These technical requirements ensure that the Hermosa Flor website is secure, scalable, responsive and optimised for both performance and user experience, while supporting future growth and enhancement.

7. Timeline and Milestones

To ensure successful completion of Hermosa Flor website Project, a structured 5-week timeline is proposed. This timeline aligns with the three phases of the module and includes key milestones for each stage.

Week	Activities	Milestone
Week 1	Define project scope Analyse existing web Gather content Create sitemap	Project Proposal Completed
Week 2	Create Basic HTML Implement Navigation links between pages Add initial content Organise file and folder structure	Functional multipage website using HTML
Week 3	Test and Debug each HTML page	Finalise testing Submit Part 1
Week 4	Apply CSS styling Improve UI/UX design	Visually styled Submit Part 2
Week 5	Add interactivity Optimise for SEO	Part 3 Completed
Week 6	Test website across different browser and devices Fix bugs and errors	Final submission

This timeline ensures steady progress, time management and alignment with academic submissions deadlines, while allowing sufficient time for testing and improvement.

8.Budget

The estimated budget for the Hermosa Flor website project is based on realistic industry costs for small to medium ecommerce websites in South Africa

Development costs

Web Development	R 12000 – R 18000
Ecommerce Setup and configuration	R 5000 – R 8000

Hosting and Domain Costs

Domain renewal	R300 – R 600 per year
Hosting Subscription	R500 – R 1200

Maintenance and Support

Website Maintenance	R1500- R 3000
Content Update	R 1000 – R 2000

Total Estimated Budget

Initial Development	R20000
Annual Running Cost	R 11000 – R 20000

The budget is scalable and sustainable, while cost effective for a growing brand like Hermosa Flor.

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